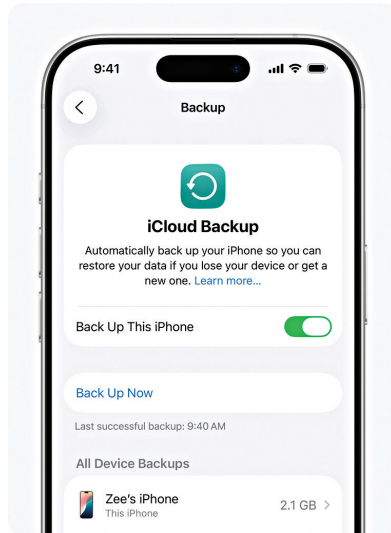


your device that is not already synced to iCloud. Apple's support pages say these backups can include things like device settings, Home Screen layout, app organisation, iMessage, text and MMS messages, some app data, purchased ringtones, and other information stored locally on the iPhone. So essentially iCloud



Backup is there to help restore the state of your device, especially the parts that are not already living in some other iCloud service.

That means iCloud Backup is less like a giant warehouse and more like a restoration kit. If your iPhone is lost, damaged, reset or replaced, that backup helps rebuild your digital life on the new

device. Apple says you can back up manually whenever you want, or turn on iCloud Backup so the iPhone backs itself up automatically when connected to Wi-Fi, connected to power, and with the screen locked.

Step-by-step: turn on iCloud Backup

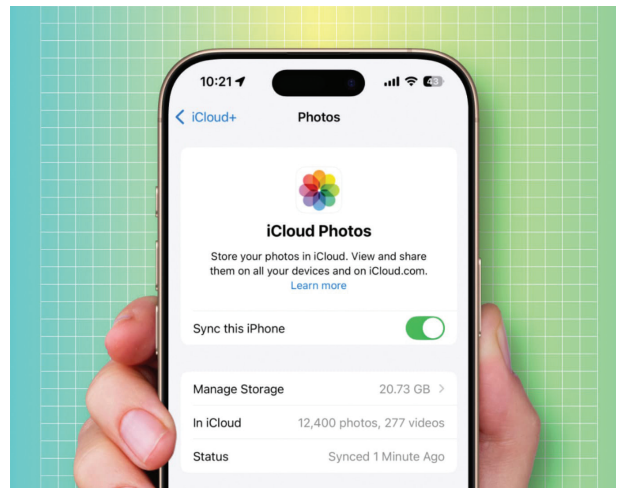
1. Open Settings.
2. Tap your name.
3. Tap iCloud.
4. Tap iCloud Backup.
5. Turn on Back Up This iPhone.
6. Connect the phone to Wi-Fi and power, and let the first backup complete. Apple says automatic backups happen when the device is on Wi-Fi, connected to power and the screen is locked.

If you want a little extra reassurance before a trip, an iOS update, or a phone swap, do a manual backup as well. Apple's support page explicitly says you can back up manually, which is useful when you want a fresh restore point right now rather than waiting for the phone's next convenient overnight mood.

What iCloud Photos actually does

Now for the part that causes the most confusion. Apple says that when you turn on iCloud Photos, every photo and video you take is uploaded to iCloud automatically, and your library is kept backed up and in sync across your devices.

But Apple also says that when iCloud Photos is on, your photos and videos are not duplicated in your iCloud backup. In



other words, the Photos library lives in iCloud Photos, not inside the iCloud Backup like a second copy hiding in a cupboard.

It's important to understand there are multiple iCloud layers at work. Contacts may sync. Notes may sync. Photos may live in iCloud Photos. Device restoration data may live in iCloud Backup. These are related, but not identical. iCloud storage is used for things like device backups, iCloud Photos and other syncing features so your content remains available across devices.

Step-by-step: turn on iCloud Photos

1. Open Settings.
2. Tap your name.
3. Tap iCloud.
4. Tap Photos.
5. Turn on Sync this iPhone. Apple says this uploads every photo and video to iCloud automatically and keeps your library in sync across your devices.

This setup is brilliant for people who live inside Apple hardware. It is also why the free 5GB tier disappears with comic speed.

The storage reality check

Apple's India iCloud+ page currently lists 5GB free, then 50GB for ₹75/month, 200GB for ₹219/month, 2TB for ₹749/month, 6TB for ₹2,999/month, and 12TB for ₹5,900/month. Apple says that space is used for photos, files, backups and more, and all iCloud+ plans can be shared with family.

For a solo iPhone user with modest photos and careful housekeeping, 50GB can be workable for a while. For a family, or for anyone shooting lots of video, 200GB is often the first tier that feels realistic. Once you combine iCloud Backup, iCloud Photos, files, and potentially multiple Apple devices in one household, 2TB begins making obvious sense.

Apple's Family Sharing page says Family Sharing lets up to six people share access to services including iCloud+, while the